FAMILY EDITION FOR PARENTS & CHILDREN (AGES 6+)



PORRIDGE FROM AN AXE

The Classic 'Stone Soup' Fable on Resourcefulness, Sharing, and Co-Creation

By Zinaida Jupiter, DBA • Published by Jupiter Group LLC

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Why Every Classic Fable Holds Two Golden Keys

Every classic folk tale carries two golden keys inside its imagery. When a child (ages 6+) listens to *PORRIDGE FROM AN AXE* in the evening, they discover how character, honesty, and foresight work without a single dry lecture. And when a parent, founder, or executive (12+) reads the very same story, they recognize timeless negotiation and governance patterns laid out clearly across our **2×2 Decision Matrix**—where the winning choice always shines in **★ Quadrant 4 (Top-Right Corner)**.

Cross-Cultural Bridge: World-renowned as 'Stone Soup' across Europe and 'Nail Soup' in Northern traditions—the universal parable of catalytic leadership and co-creation.

> **Proverb of the Book:** *"Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot."*

Zinaida Jupiter, DBA
Creator of the Jupiter Wisdom Tales Series & 2×2 Decision Matrix Methodology

❧ SHEET I. A TIRED TRAVELLER AT A GUARDED DOOR ❧



One autumn evening a cheerful craftsman walked through a quiet village looking for a warm hearth to rest for the night. He knocked at the cottage of an old hostess whose pantry was full of grain, butter, and salt—yet out of fear of scarcity, she sighed: 'Alas, good traveller, my cupboards are completely bare! I have nothing at all to set on the table.'

Instead of arguing or complaining, the craftsman smiled warmly: 'Do not worry, dear hostess! If there is nothing else, I can cook a rich, fragrant porridge out of a clean iron axe head!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot."*

❧ SHEET II. THE BOILING CAULDRON AND THE SPARK OF CURIOSITY ❧



Intrigued by such a marvel, the hostess brought a pot of spring water and a scrubbed axe head without a handle. The craftsman placed the pot over the hearth fire, stirred the bubbling water with a wooden spoon, and tasted a drop with relish.

'How rich and savoury it is turning out!' he declared. 'It will be ready in a moment—though if we had just a tiny handful of millet or oats, it would be fit for a royal feast!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot."*

❧ SHEET III. A HANDFUL OF GRAIN AND A SPOONFUL OF GOLDEN BUTTER ❧



Drawn into the shared venture, the hostess hurried to her storeroom and brought a bowl of golden millet: 'Here, add this so the recipe succeeds!' Five minutes later the craftsman tasted the steaming broth again.

'Simply wonderful! Only a pinch of salt and a small spoon of fresh butter would crown the dish!' Gladly the hostess brought both salt and butter, proud to see the cauldron thickening.

> ***Key Insight:*** *“Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot.”*

❧ SHEET IV. A SHARED FEAST AROUND THE WARM TABLE ❧



Soon the cottage was filled with the aroma of hearty, buttery porridge. Sitting down together with two wooden spoons, the hostess marvelled: 'I never dreamed such delicious porridge could be made from an iron axe! Only tell me—when shall we eat the axe itself?'

The craftsman laughed kindly: 'The axe has not quite softened yet—I shall carry it with me and finish cooking it at the next village!'

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot."*

❧ SHEET V. THE CATALYST OF ABUNDANCE: HOW INITIATIVE UNLOCKS TRUST ❧



Both the hostess and the traveller finished their supper warm, cheerful, and grateful. Nobody was poorer; instead, a frozen pantry had become a joyful feast.

From this world-famous 'Stone Soup' parable, families and leaders learn a powerful law: never beg for a finished banquet—light the hearth first, put a working prototype on the fire, and invite everyone to contribute one small gift to the shared pot!

> ***Key Insight:*** *"Where hearts are closed, even a full pantry feels empty; where one cheerful hand lights the fire, everyone brings grain to the pot."*

Three Evening Questions for Parents & Children

- **1. Why did the hostess say she had nothing at first, and then gladly bring grain, salt, and butter?**
  Why is it scary when someone asks for 'everything at once,' yet fun and easy when we build something step by step together?
- **2. What was the real magic of the iron axe in the pot?**
  Did the iron itself turn into porridge, or did the craftsman's cheerful initiative turn distrust into teamwork?
- **3. How can we cook 'Stone Soup' in our family or classroom?**
  When a game or project seems boring, how can each person add one small idea to make it amazing for everyone?

Interactive Choice Game: “Three Roads”

Situation: *Your friends are sitting on the bench saying 'There is nothing to do and nobody has a full game set!'*

Path 1 (Grumbling in the Corner): Complain that nobody brought enough toys and go home bored.

Path 2 (Demanding Everything from Others): Order your friends to hand over all their things while you do nothing.

★ Path 3 — The Wise Choice (The Stone Soup Catalyst!): Start building the first tower or story yourself and invite each friend to add one piece so everyone shares the joy!

❖ **Creative Task: Draw the bubbling cauldron over the warm hearth with all the good ingredients that turn scarcity into a feast of friendship!**
24-Hour Family Habit: Cook or build something together where each family member adds 'one handful of grain'—and praise every contribution!

VERTICAL AXIS Y ↑: INITIATIVE & CREATIVE SPARK → | HORIZONTAL AXIS X ►: HONESTY & SHARED JOY AT THE TABLE

Lesson II • Clever Trick Without Friendship
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Getting what you want by slyness while leaving the other person feeling fooled.

★ FEAST OF SHARED CO-CREATION
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING CHOICE: Y+, X+)
One warm initiative unlocks generosity so everyone at the table is fed, respected, and happy.

Lesson I • Closed Pantry of Scarcity
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Sitting on resources in fear and complaining that 'nothing can be done.'

Lesson III • Waiting for Someone Else
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Wishing for a warm dinner while nobody takes the first step to light the stove.

Two Golden Vows of the Tale:

1. Be the first to light the hearth: Do not wait for ideal conditions—start with what is in your hands today.

2. Invite everyone to add one small gift: People love and protect what they helped build with their own hands.

Who Is Who in Business, Governance & Negotiations

- **1. The Craftsman — Venture Catalyst & Ecosystem Orchestrator:** Brings the core architecture and momentum ('the boiling pot'), unlocking idle capital and capabilities across partners.
- **2. The Guarded Hostess — Risk-Averse Asset Holder:** Possesses capital, infrastructure, or distribution ('grain and butter'), but refuses cold upfront requests until she sees a live prototype.
- **3. The Iron Axe — Minimum Viable Prototype (MVP) / Anchor:** The tangible starting point that shifts a conversation from abstract begging to concrete co-creation.
- **4. Grain, Salt & Butter — Incremental Partner Commitments:** Modular contributions that stakeholders gladly invest once they feel ownership of the emerging win.

Strategic Traps & The ★ Quadrant 4 Solution

> **Trap 1 — Asking Risk-Averse Partners for the Entire Budget on Day One:** Pitching a massive slide deck with zero working prototype triggers an automatic 'My cupboards are bare' refusal.

> **Trap 2 — Using Manipulation Instead of Genuine Co-Creation:** If stakeholders feel tricked rather than enriched, the consortium collapses after a single transaction.

> **★ The Quadrant 4 Solution — Catalyst MVP & Modular Co-Investment:** Launch a working core with your own resources, demonstrate traction, and invite partners to add modular assets for shared upside.

AXIS Y ↑: CATALYST INITIATIVE & WORKING MVP → | AXIS X ►: SHARED VALUE & PARTNER OWNERSHIP (ZERO-SUM MANIPULATION → TRUE WIN-WIN CO-CREATION)

Quadrant 2 • One-Time Hustle
(Upper-Left: Y+, X–)
Securing resources through hype without delivering lasting shared value to contributors.

★ ECOSYSTEM CO-CREATION ENGINE
(★ TOP-RIGHT WINNING QUADRANT: Y+, X+)
Strong working prototype that aligns multiple partners into a high-trust, high-yield alliance.

Quadrant 1 • Frozen Scarcity Deadlock
(Lower-Left: Y–, X–)
Everyone hoards budgets in silos and waits for someone else to take the first risk.

Quadrant 3 • Polite Committee With No Pot
(Lower-Right: Y–, X+)
Endless meetings about cooperation without anyone putting a working MVP on the fire.

Executive Vocabulary & Boardroom Action Phrases

Idiom	Diagnostic Meaning	★ Quadrant 4 Action
"Put the axe in the boiling water first!"	Stop asking for full budget approval on a slide deck—ship a working prototype this week.	**★ Build a 48-hour live demo before the partner meeting.**
"Ask for a handful of millet, not the whole barn"	Lower the partner's initial commitment threshold so they can say 'Yes' easily.	**★ Propose a low-risk 2-week pilot with one modular integration.**
"Let the partner add their own spoon of butter"	Co-created solutions enjoy 10x higher adoption than top-down mandates.	**★ Invite the client's team to co-design the final workflow.**
"Keep the iron axe for the next village"	Retain your reusable core platform IP while delivering a full feast of value to every client.	**★ License the core engine while customizing the implementation.**

International Contract & Governance Standard:
Consortium Seed/MVP Co-Investment Agreement; Modular Partner Contribution Schedule; Core IP Retention License.

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